

FINAL SUBMISSION REPORT

Internship Organization: CRY – Child Rights and You

Intern Name: Annapurna Das

Course: M.Sc. Economics

Duration: 8 Weeks (June – July 2025)

Primary Theme: Research, Documentation and Fundraising

1. Introduction

My internship at CRY – Child Rights and You was more than just an academic requirement; it was an immersive experience that allowed me to connect my economics background with the practical realities of child welfare and development. Over a span of eight weeks, I worked on assignments that revolved around three pillars: research, documentation, and fundraising.

As an economics student, I have studied how social policies, institutional frameworks, and resource allocation affect development outcomes. At CRY, I had the opportunity to see these dynamics up close. I learned that child rights are not only a matter of ethics and morality, but also a foundation for long-term economic growth. Investing in children's education, protection, and well-being is essentially investing in the future human capital of the country.

My work allowed me to contribute to CRY's mission in three key ways:

1. Researching and creating awareness materials on child rights and safeguarding policies.
2. Documenting and evaluating project activities to track progress and impact.
3. Participating in fundraising for girl child education to promote gender equity in education access.

2. Research and Documentation

A. Child Rights and Justice in India

One of my major assignments was preparing a comprehensive presentation on the legislative and policy framework protecting children in India. I covered laws such as the Right to Education Act, the Juvenile Justice Act, the Prohibition of Child Marriage Act, and the Child Labour Act, linking them to broader socio-economic realities like poverty, gender inequality, and regional disparities.

While researching, I realised that laws alone are not enough. Their success depends on how well they are enforced, the resources available to support implementation, and the willingness of communities to embrace change. I used examples and data to highlight the economic cost of child marriage, child labour, and school dropouts, framing these not only as social issues but as economic setbacks.

B. Child Safeguarding Policy

I also developed a presentation on CRY's Child Safeguarding Policy for internal awareness and training. This policy sets out principles, codes of conduct, reporting mechanisms, and legal compliance guidelines to ensure the safety and dignity of every child involved in CRY's programmes.

While drafting the content, I focused on making the policy actionable and relevant to real-life situations, whether in classrooms, community events, or online spaces. Safeguarding, I realised, is as much about creating a culture of trust and respect as it is about preventing harm. From an economic lens, a safe environment ensures that investments in education and welfare yield their intended results.

3. Project Pragati – Report Making

Project Pragati focuses on education and protection for children in vulnerable communities. My role in this project involved compiling reports that documented progress, recorded stakeholder feedback, and highlighted areas for improvement.

This was more than just data entry. It required analysing trends, identifying bottlenecks, and understanding the reasons behind successes and setbacks. For example, an increase in school retention rates was linked to better mid-day meal provision, which not only addressed hunger but also encouraged regular attendance. Such small interventions can have large economic and social ripple effects over time.

I also suggested ways to enhance monitoring and optimise resource use, ensuring that the programme remains both effective and sustainable.

4. Fundraising for Girl Child Education

Alongside my research and documentation work, I contributed to a fundraising initiative that raised ₹5,009 for the education of girls. The process taught me that successful fundraising combines facts with emotional connection. I used both personal stories and economic arguments to appeal to donors, showing that educating girls leads to higher incomes, delayed marriage, improved family health, and better educational outcomes for the next generation.

Maintaining transparency was an important part of the process. Donors were given clear information about how their contributions would be used, which helped build trust and encouraged further engagement.

5. Skills and Insights

Over the eight weeks, I developed skills that will be valuable for both academic and professional pursuits:

- Conducting in-depth policy and socio-economic research.
- Creating structured, data-backed presentations and reports.
- Communicating complex issues in a way that is accessible and engaging.
- Understanding the economics behind social issues like education and child protection.
- Building donor relationships and linking contributions to measurable outcomes.

I also came away with a deeper appreciation for the interconnectedness of research, documentation, and fundraising. Research identifies needs and solutions, documentation proves impact, and fundraising ensures sustainability.

6. Challenges Faced

The main challenges were incomplete or inconsistent field data, translating technical policy language into plain terms, and managing overlapping deadlines for different assignments. I overcame these by verifying information across multiple sources, breaking large tasks into smaller goals, and keeping a disciplined work schedule.

7. Conclusion

The eight weeks I spent at CRY gave me a front-row seat to how policy, economics, and social action come together to create real change. I learned that improving child rights is not just about passing laws; it is about ensuring those laws work in practice, backed by adequate resources and community support.

This internship has strengthened my resolve to pursue work that blends data-driven research, policy analysis, and on-ground programme engagement. Whether in the classroom, the field, or the policy space, I want to continue contributing to initiatives that empower children, promote education, and address inequalities at their root.